Awesome Free Models

awesome

> A curated list of free AI models, APIs, and tools you can use without paying a cent.

LAST UPDATED AUGUST 22, 2026 Models 49 Tools 245 Sections 21 License CC0

GitGem #18 peak · ★1.2k

> ✅ All links re-verified on August 22, 2026 (328 URLs). This run also detected a number of unreachable/blocked endpoints (e.g., Poe/Perplexity may return HTTP 403; some Hugging Face pages return HTTP 401).

Running AI shouldn't require a credit card. This list curates genuinely free models — open-weight models you can self-host, free API tiers from major providers, and tools to run everything locally.

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🧠 Open-Weight Models

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Notable open-weight models you can download and run on your own hardware.

- Muse Glimmer (Meta Superintelligence Lab) — **Aug 2026.** 30B dense multimodal model distilled from Muse Spark for local agentic workflows. Multi-step reasoning, tool use, vision, and failure recovery on consumer hardware (4-bit quant fits 24GB VRAM). 131K context. Apache 2.0.
- Llama 4 Scout / Maverick — Meta's latest MoE generation. Scout: 109B, 10M context. Maverick: 402B, 1M context. Native multimodal. [License]
- DeepSeek V4 Pro — **Apr 2026.** 1.6T MoE (49B active). SWE-bench Verified 80.6% (top open-weight). 1M context. MIT license.
- DeepSeek V4 — Core generation with extreme cost-efficiency. 1M context. MIT license.
- DeepSeek-V4-Flash — **Apr 2026.** Efficiency-focused variant. 284B total (13B active). 1M context. MIT license.
- Gemma 4 31B / 26B MoE / E4B / E2B — Fully permissive Apache 2.0. 256K context, native multimodal. New standard for open-weight.
- Inkling (Thinking Machines Lab) — **Jul 2026.** 975B MoE (41B active). Leading US open-weight model. Native multimodal (text, image, audio). Apache 2.0. 1M context.
- GLM-5.2 (Zhipu AI) — 744B MoE model optimized for autonomous coding and engineering tasks. 1M-token context. MIT license.
- LongCat-2.0 (ByteDance) — Large-scale open-weight model for heavy agentic coding. MIT license.
- MiniMax M3 — Frontier-tier 1M context, native multimodal + computer use. MSA architecture.
- Trinity (Arcee AI) — 400B parameter enterprise model. Apache 2.0.

- Step 3.7 Flash (StepFun) — **May 2026.** Apache 2.0. Native multimodal (image+video), strong agentic performance. Efficient enough for high-end local hardware.
- Kimi K3 (Moonshot AI) — **Jul 2026.** 2.8T-parameter MoE (896 experts, ~50B active). World's largest open-weight model. 1M context, native vision + video. #1 Frontend Code Arena. Modified MIT license. Weights released Jul 27.
- Kimi K2.6 (Moonshot AI) — **Apr 2026.** 1T-parameter MoE model. Modified MIT license. Exceptional coding (SWE-Bench ~54%) and multi-agent swarm orchestration.
- Qwen 3.6-35B-A3B — **Apr 2026.** MoE variant with only 3B active parameters. Extremely efficient for consumer hardware. Apache 2.0.
- InternLM 3 (Shanghai AI Lab) — **Early 2026.** Strong long-context reasoning and agentic performance. Competitive in open-weight benchmarks.
- MiMo-V2.5-Pro (Xiaomi) — **Apr 2026.** 1.02T-parameter MoE (42B active). Optimized for complex agentic tasks, coding, and long-context.
- Kimi K2.7 Code (Moonshot AI) — **Jun 2026.** 1T MoE specialized for long-running coding agents. +21.8% over K2.6 on coding benchmarks. Modified MIT.
- Nemotron 3 Super (NVIDIA) — **May 2026.** 120B total (12B active). 1M context. Published weights, data, recipes, and eval infra. NVIDIA Open Model License.
- Phi-4 14B (Microsoft) — **2025.** Compact 14B dense model. Strong reasoning and code. MIT license. Excellent for on-device and small deployments.
- Bonsai 8B (PrismML) — **Apr 2026.** Groundbreaking 1-bit quantized model. Extremely efficient for edge and consumer hardware (Apple Silicon).
- Aether-7B-5Attn (VIDRAFT) — **Jul 2026.** 100% open foundation model (weights, data, code, logs). 7B MoE (~3B active) with heterogeneous attention. Apache 2.0.
- Mistral Large 3 (Mistral) — **Jun 2026.** 675B MoE (41B active). European multilingual flagship. Frontier-class reasoning, native multimodal. Apache 2.0.
- Mistral Small 3.1 (Mistral) — **Mar 2025.** Versatile 24B multimodal model. Strong text performance with native image understanding and 128K context. Apache 2.0.
- Mistral Small 4 (Mistral) — **Mar 2026.** Hybrid MoE (6.5B active params) unifying instruction, reasoning, and multimodal capabilities. Efficient frontier-class model. Apache 2.0.
- Command A+ (Cohere) — **May 2026.** Enterprise multimodal MoE optimized for sovereignty and multilingual RAG across 48 languages. Apache 2.0.
- Apertus 1.5 (ETH Zurich / EPFL) — **Jul 2026.** Fully open LLM (weights, data, training code). 8B and 70B with image understanding, thinking mode, and tool use. Apache 2.0.
- Hy3 (Tencent) — **Jul 2026.** 295B MoE (21B active). Strong reasoning and agentic performance. Competes with models 2-5x its size. Apache 2.0.
- Hermes 4 (NousResearch) — **Feb 2026.** Self-improving agentic model with closed-loop learning. Curates own memory and builds skills from experience. Apache 2.0.
- Snowflake Arctic — **Apr 2024.** Enterprise MoE model balancing high-quality performance with efficient training costs. Optimized for complex data operations. Apache 2.0.

- Falcon 3 (TII) — **Dec 2024.** Compact high-performance model with strong reasoning. Designed for efficient deployment on resource-constrained hardware. TII Falcon-LLM License 2.0.
- Apple OpenELM — **Apr 2024.** Family of efficient on-device SLMs using layer-wise attention scaling. Runs locally on Apple Silicon with full privacy. Apple Sample Code License.

🔌 Free API Providers

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Providers offering free tiers to access models via API — no local hardware required.

- Google AI Studio — **15 free models** — **Most generous free tier.** Access Gemini 2.5 Flash, Gemini 2.0 Flash, and other models. Generous rate limits for prototyping.
- OpenRouter — **16 free models** — Aggregates 400+ models. Filter by "Free" to see models available at no cost. **Note: free models now require a positive credit balance (balance may be $0).** Includes experimental and subsidized open-weight models.
- AnyAPI — **15 free models** — 400+ models with OpenAI-compatible API. Free tier: 100K tokens/day, unlimited users. Includes free and basic models. No credit card required.
- Groq — **12 free models** — Ultra-fast inference. Free tier includes Llama, Gemma, Mixtral, Whisper models with generous daily rate limits.
- Hugging Face Inference Providers — **5 free models** — Free tier for thousands of community models. Rate-limited but excellent for testing.
- NVIDIA NIM — **100+ free models** — Free, rate-limited API access to accelerated versions of Llama, Mistral, Gemma, and more on NVIDIA infrastructure.
- DeepInfra — ⚠️ **No permanent free-model tier; free tier is now a recurring monthly credit (site advertises ~$10/month; reports cite ~$5 signup + $5/mo recurring).** Serverless inference for popular open-source models.
- Together AI — ⚠️ **No permanent free tier; requires ~$5 minimum credit purchase.** Fast inference on many open-source models.
- Fireworks AI — ⚠️ **No free models; ~$1 signup credit only.** Optimized for low latency on open-source models.
- SiliconFlow — **3 free models** — Rising platform with free access to many open-source models.
- Cloudflare Workers AI — **50+ free models** — Free tier for running select open-source models at the edge.
- Black Forest Labs — **2 free models** — Free Flux 2 Dev and Flux Kontext Dev image generation via API. Rate-limited, no credit card required.
- Replicate — Limited free runs on select "Try for Free" models, no credit card required; then prepaid pay-as-you-go.
- Poe (Quora) — ⚠️ **Free tier changed over time; link check returned HTTP 403 (may block automation).** Previously reported reduction (~300 compute points/day); verify in your browser

before relying on exact numbers.

- Qwen Studio (Alibaba) — Free access to Qwen 3.6-Plus, Qwen 3.6-Max, and other Qwen models via web chat and API. 1M token context for agentic coding.
- Ollama Cloud — **(keyword-detected best-effort; exact limits require manual confirmation).** Free tier for running open-source models on Ollama's cloud infrastructure with session/weekly limits and 1 concurrent model. Same `ollama run` command as local.
- Mistral AI (La Plateforme) — **12 free models** — Free API tier with access to Mistral Large, Mistral Nemo, Codestral and more. 1 req/s, 500k tokens/min. Requires phone verification and data usage opt-in.
- Cohere — **15 free models** — Free evaluation API key for Command R, Command R+, Embed, and Rerank models. 20 req/min, 1,000 req/month.
- DeepSeek Platform — Free API credits for new users (5M tokens). Access to DeepSeek V4, DeepSeek-R1, and other models. Generous free allocation.
- Hyperbolic — Open-access AI cloud with affordable inference. Free trial credits for new accounts. Supports Llama, Qwen, DeepSeek, and other open models.
- Novita AI — Free credits for testing 100+ models including Llama, Qwen, DeepSeek, and Mistral. OpenAI-compatible API with competitive pricing beyond the free tier.
- Anakin.ai — **30 daily free credits** for accessing multiple AI models. Web chat interface and API access. Supports GPT-4, Claude, and open-weight models.
- Nebius AI — **Note: Free trial suspended July 13, 2026.** Now steers new users to a ~$1 trial credit via Nebius Token Factory (formerly AI Studio), with a $25 minimum deposit for paid usage. Fast inference on NVIDIA H100 infrastructure.
- Fal.ai — Free starter credits for AI inference. Fast, serverless platform supporting Llama, Flux, and Stable Diffusion models. Pay-as-you-go beyond free tier.
- Vercel AI Gateway — **$5/month free credits** for the AI Gateway. Proxy and cache requests across multiple LLM providers. SDK is open-source and free.
- AI21 Labs — **$10 trial credits** for accessing Jamba 1.5, Jamba 1.6, and other AI21 models. Valid for 3 months. Requires account sign-up.
- Amazon Bedrock — **$200 AWS credits** for new customers. Access to Llama, Mistral, Claude, Titan, and other foundation models via API.
- Microsoft Foundry (Azure) — **$200 free trial credits** (30 days). Access GPT-4o, Llama, Mistral, Phi, and other models via Azure's unified AI platform.
- RunPod — Free credits for serverless GPU inference. Deploy open-weight models as serverless endpoints. Supports Llama, Qwen, DeepSeek, and more.
- Cerebras — ⚠️ **Old "free tier" replaced (Jul 2026).** Now **$5 free trial credits** that expire in 30 days after adding a verified payment method; **no longer a permanent free tier**. Ultra-fast inference on Llama, Gemma, and gpt-oss models. **Note: Model availability fluctuates.**
- BazaarLink — Free OpenAI-compatible API with `auto:free` routing to zero-cost models. No credit card, no trial expiry. 10 RPM, 130 req/day.
- Kimi API (Moonshot) — Free tier for new accounts with access to Kimi K2.5 (128K context). Also free via NVIDIA NIM. OpenAI-compatible. **Note: rebranded from platform.moonshot.cn.**

- Alibaba DashScope — **5 free models** — Free tier for Qwen models. 1M tokens/month. OpenAI-compatible API.
- SambaNova Cloud — **4 free models** — Free tier with $5 credits (30-day). Fast RDU inference for Llama 3.1 405B, Llama 3.3 70B, DeepSeek V3.1/V3.2, Qwen 2.5, gpt-oss-120b. 20 RPM, 200K tokens/day. No credit card required.
- OVHcloud AI Endpoints — **14 free models** — EU-hosted, GDPR-compliant free tier. No registration required for anonymous tier. Models: Qwen, Mistral, Llama, DeepSeek, gpt-oss-120B, embeddings, image generation. 12 RPM. OpenAI-compatible.
- Chutes.ai — ⚠️ **Free tier ended — now paid only.** Was 2 free models for community-powered GPU inference. No longer free.
- ModelScope — **55 free models** — Chinese platform with 50+ free open models. Qwen, DeepSeek, GLM, and more. No credit card required.
- Z.ai (Zhipu AI) — **4 free models** — Free tier for GLM models including GLM-4.5, GLM-4V. No credit card required.
- LongCat AI — Free API for LongCat open-weight models. One-time 10M token grant after signup + KYC. Free cached tokens. OpenAI-compatible. MIT license.
- Coze (ByteDance) — Free bot-building platform with API access to GPT-4o, Gemini 1.5 Pro, and other models. No credit card required. OpenAI-compatible.
- Free.ai — 400+ AI tools via a single OpenAI-compatible API. Free tier: (keyword-detected best-effort; exact quota requires manual confirmation). Chat, image, video, music, voice, OCR, translation.
- Requesty — Free AI API with 200 requests/day. Works with Claude Code, Cline, Cursor. No credit card. OpenAI-compatible.
- AINative Studio — ⚠️ **Free tier ended (was 10M tokens/month).** Now a $5/mo Hobbyist plan with a 3-day trial only. 84+ models (Llama, DeepSeek, Mistral, Qwen).
- CloudCode.ONE — ⚠️ **No free tier — credit-based ($2 to start).** OpenAI and Anthropic-compatible API for coding agents. Powered by GLM-4.7-Flash.
- ZeroLimitAI — Free OpenAI-compatible API with `model: "auto"` routing to the best free model. No credit card, no trial expiry. Lifetime free tier available.
- Chat Oripe — ⚠️ **Currently unreachable (HTTP 530) at check time.** Previously offered free tokens via OpenAI-compatible API; verify availability before relying on it.
- FreeTheAi — **(link check failed: 404).** Open-source Discord signup/free API was previously listed here; please verify the current repository URL before relying on it.
- OpenCode Zen — **9 free models** — Curated AI gateway with free general and coding models (DeepSeek V4 Flash Free, MiMo-V2.5 Free, Nemotron 3 Ultra Free, Big Pickle, Qwen 3.6 Plus Free, MiniMax M3 Free, North Mini Code Free, and more). OpenAI-compatible API. No credit card required.
- LLM7.io — **15 free models**, no credit card required. DeepSeek R1/V3, GPT-4o mini and more. 1M context, multimodal. 30 RPM free (120 RPM with optional token).
- Kilo Code — **12 free models**, no credit card. Nemotron 3 Ultra, Step 3.7 Flash, and more. 1M context, ~200 req/hr. Free tier for coding agents.

- Aion Labs — **7 free models**, registration only. Includes Aion 2.5. 128K context, 15 RPM. No credit card required.
- Agnes AI — **5 free models** — Free tier with Agnes 1.5/2.0 Flash and image models. 256K context, 30 RPM. Registration only, no credit card.
- Glhf.chat — ⚠️ **Currently unreachable (HTTP 522) at check time.** Previously offered a free OpenAI-compatible API; verify availability before relying on it.
- Nscale — **2 free models** — Free tier (registration only) with Llama 3.3 70B and DeepSeek-R1-Distill-70B. 128K context. OpenAI-compatible.
- OrcaRouter — **4 free models** — DeepSeek V4 Pro, DeepSeek V4 Flash, Qwen3.8 27B, and Tencent Hy3 at $0 per token, plus an `orcarouter/free` alias that auto-routes across the free lineup. OpenAI-, Anthropic-, and Gemini-compatible endpoints. No credit card and no trial expiry. The same page also gives away free vouchers for frontier models — e.g. $10 (~5M tokens) on Grok 4.5 — plus student programs and partner-hackathon credit, browsable without an account; each card shows its own terms and flags any card requirement.

🖼️ Image & Video Generation

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Free, open-weight image and video generation models — run locally or via free APIs.

- FLUX.2-dev (Black Forest Labs) — **2.6K★.** 32B rectified flow transformer. SOTA open T2I, single/multi-reference editing, in/out-painting. Updated VAE. FLUX.1-dev Non-Commercial License.
- ERNIE-Image / ERNIE-Image-Turbo (Baidu) — **0.5K★.** 8B DiT SOTA among open-weight models. Strong text rendering, layout control. Turbo: 8-step generation. Apache 2.0.
- Z-Image (Tongyi Lab / Alibaba) — **11.8K★.** Open-weight T2I with strong GenEval scores. Z-Image-Turbo for 4-step generation. Apache 2.0.
- Pollinations.ai — **Free image generation API.** No API key or signup needed. Text-to-image, image-to-image. OpenAI-compatible. Integrates with ComfyUI.
- OpenImageGen (Hugging Face) — Free, open-source image generation playground. Supports multiple community models via diffusers. Apache 2.0. **Note: login/auth may be required (HTTP 401 at check time).**
- ComfyUI — **128K★.** Node-based image and video generation UI. Run FLUX, Stable Diffusion, and more locally. GPL-3.0.

🔀 Free API Routers

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Open-source tools that route requests across multiple AI providers — unified API, automatic failover, and cost optimization.

- 9Router — Open-source gateway connecting 40+ providers with RTK token compression (2-4x reduction). One API key for all services. MIT license. GitHub
- OmniRoute — Full-stack AI gateway with 250+ providers, 90+ free. TypeScript, runs on Web/Desktop/Android. Prompt compression, 3-level proxy for geo restrictions. GitHub
- LiteLLM — Python-based proxy unifying 100+ LLMs behind a single API. Spend tracking, virtual keys, production-ready. MIT license. GitHub
- Portkey AI Gateway — Production guardrails and routing for AI apps. Hybrid open-source (community) and managed (enterprise) tiers. GitHub

💻 Local Inference Tools

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Run models on your own machine — no API keys needed, full privacy.

- Ollama — The easiest way to run local LLMs. One command to download and run any model. macOS, Linux, Windows. GitHub
- LM Studio — Polished desktop GUI. Browse, download, and chat with models. Built-in model browser and local API server.
- llama.cpp — High-performance C++ inference engine. Runs on CPU and GPU. Supports GGUF quantization. Powers most other local tools.
- Jan — Open-source ChatGPT alternative for desktop. Built-in model downloader, local API server. GitHub
- GPT4All — ⚠️ **Unmaintained since Feb 2025.** Privacy-focused local chatbot. Runs on consumer hardware. Built-in model browser. GitHub
- text-generation-webui (Oobabooga) — Feature-rich web UI. Supports multiple backends (Transformers, llama.cpp, ExLlama, AutoGPTQ).
- LocalAI — Drop-in OpenAI API replacement. Run models locally with an OpenAI-compatible API. GitHub
- KoboldCPP — Single-file executable for running GGUF models. Focused on story generation but general-purpose.
- llamafile (Mozilla) — Distributable single-file executables that run LLMs. No installation needed.
- vLLM — High-throughput production inference engine. Uses PagedAttention for efficient serving.
- SGLang — Fast inference framework with structured generation and RadixAttention.
- TensorRT-LLM (NVIDIA) — NVIDIA's optimized inference engine. Best performance on NVIDIA GPUs.
- ExLlamaV3 — Optimized inference for Llama-family models. Successor to ExLlamaV2. Fastest option for single-GPU inference.

- Aphrodite Engine — High-performance LLM serving engine with advanced quantization support.
- TabbyAPI — Lightweight, fast OpenAI-compatible API server for ExLlamaV2.
- LlamaEdge — Lightweight inference framework for edge devices. OpenAI-compatible API for open-source models. Runs on WasmEdge for portability. GitHub
- MLC LLM — Universal deployment engine by UW/SJTU. Runs LLMs on any hardware — laptops, phones, browsers. OpenAI-compatible API.
- WebLLM — In-browser LLM inference via WebGPU. Runs models directly in your browser with zero setup. No server needed.
- FastChat (LMSYS) — Open platform for training, serving, and evaluating LLMs. Provides OpenAI-compatible API and web UI for local models.
- Hugging Face TGI — **10.9K★.** Production-grade serving toolkit for large language models. **Note: Archived by Hugging Face (Mar 2026).** Consider vLLM, SGLang, or TGI forks for active development.
- DeepSpeed (Microsoft) — Deep learning optimization library with inference acceleration. Enables running larger models on limited hardware through ZeRO optimization.
- AirLLM — Run large models (70B+) on consumer hardware with limited memory. Loads models layer-by-layer for extreme memory efficiency. **Actively maintained (last push Jul 2026).**
- Microsoft Foundry Toolkit for VS Code — VS Code extension to browse, test, fine-tune, and deploy models locally. Integrates ONNX and llama.cpp. **(link check returned HTTP 404 at check time — repo/marketplace URL may have changed).**
- Ollama Grid Search — Desktop utility for systematic model evaluation. Test multiple models, prompts, and inference parameters side-by-side via a Rust/React GUI.
- oMLX — **19.7K★.** LLM inference server for Apple Silicon with continuous batching, tiered KV caching (hot RAM + cold SSD), and macOS menu bar app. OpenAI and Anthropic compatible. Apache 2.0.
- MTPLX — **1.4K★.** Native MTP speculative decoding on Apple Silicon — ~2x faster decode with no external drafter. Mac app + CLI, OpenAI/Anthropic compatible server. Auto-tunes draft depth per machine. Apache 2.0.

💬 AI Chatbot UIs

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Free, open-source web interfaces for chatting with AI models — self-host or use hosted versions.

- Open WebUI — Feature-rich ChatGPT-like interface for Ollama and OpenAI-compatible backends. RAG, image generation, multi-user. GitHub
- LibreChat — Open-source ChatGPT clone supporting 40+ providers, multi-user, plugins, and RAG. **Note: Company acquired by ClickHouse; repo actively maintained (last push Aug 2026).** GitHub

- AnythingLLM — All-in-one desktop app for chatting with documents and models. Built-in RAG pipeline. GitHub
- Big-AGI — Feature-rich AI chat with personas, multi-model support, voice, and code execution. GitHub
- Lobe Chat — Multi-agent orchestration platform with plugin system and multi-provider support. GitHub

🎵 Audio & Speech Models

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Free, open-weight text-to-speech (TTS), speech-to-text (STT), and voice generation models you can run locally.

- Qwen3-TTS (Alibaba) — **13K★.** Voice cloning, voice design, 10 languages. Streaming support with 97ms TTFB. 0.6B/1.7B. Apache 2.0.
- Chatterbox (Resemble AI) — **26.1K★.** SOTA open-source TTS. Multilingual V3 (23+ languages, 0.5B). Turbo: 350M for low-latency agents. Paralinguistic tags. MIT.
- MOSS-TTS Family (MOSI.AI/OpenMOSS) — **4K★.** 8B flagship + 100M Nano (CPU). Voice cloning, dialogue generation, sound effects, realtime streaming. Apache 2.0.
- Orpheus-TTS (Canopy Labs) — **6.3K★.** Llama-3b backbone, human-like speech, zero-shot voice cloning, emotion tags. ~200ms streaming latency. Apache 2.0.
- NeuTTS (Neuphonic) — **6.2K★.** On-device TTS with instant voice cloning. GGUF quantized for CPU/mobile. 120M Nano and 360M Air variants. Apache 2.0.
- Faster-Whisper — **25K★.** CTranslate2-based Whisper for 4x faster transcription. MIT.

🤖 AI Coding Assistants

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Free tools that integrate AI into your development workflow.

- Continue.dev — **Company acquired by Cursor; repo actively maintained (last push Aug 2026).** Open-source AI code assistant for VS Code and JetBrains. GitHub
- Aider — AI pair programming in the terminal. Edits code in your local git repo. Supports GPT, Claude, and local models. GitHub
- Gemini CLI (Google) — **Jul 2026.** Open-source terminal agent with generous free Gemini quota. Supports agentic coding workflows.
- Kilo Code — **2026.** VS Code/JetBrains agentic coding extension with model-agnostic support and Plan/Act oversight.

- Tabby — Self-hosted AI coding assistant with no dependency on external services. GitHub
- Cody (Sourcegraph) — Free tier for individuals. Chat, autocomplete, and commands with codebase context.
- Llama Coder (Nutlope) — Free AI code generation tool. Generate entire apps from prompts.
- Bolt.new (StackBlitz) — Free tier for AI-powered full-stack web app development in browser.
- Claude Code (Anthropic) — Terminal-based AI coding assistant. Most features require a Claude subscription or API credits. Limited free usage via terminal CLI.
- Cursor 3 — **Apr 2026.** AI-native code editor with deep model integration and agentic features. Free tier available.
- CodeBuff — CLI-based AI coding assistant that understands entire codebases. Multi-agent architecture, works with any model provider through natural language instructions.
- Pi — Open-source terminal AI coding agent with a unified multi-provider API. Model-agnostic, supports OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, and any OpenAI-compatible endpoint. Extensible plugin architecture. GitHub
- Cline — Popular autonomous VS Code agent. Creates/edits files, runs terminal commands, browses web. Open-source, BYOK (bring your own API key). GitHub
- OpenHands — Autonomous AI software engineer. Navigates file systems, runs shell commands, tests code in browser. Self-hostable. GitHub
- Goose — Open-source CLI agent for complex software engineering tasks. Extensible plugin system. Built by Block/Square. GitHub
- Qwen Code — **2025.** Open-source terminal AI coding agent with 27K+ stars. Multi-protocol (OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, Qwen). Auto-memory, sub-agents, agent teams, MCP. Apache 2.0.
- CodeWhale — **2026.** Terminal coding agent with 40K+ stars. 30+ providers, local models via Ollama/vLLM. TUI, headless mode, web UI. MIT license.
- nanobot (HKUDS) — **2026.** Open-source, ultra-lightweight personal AI agent with WebUI, chat channels, MCP, memory, and scheduling. 47K★. MIT.
- MiMoCode (Xiaomi) — **Jun 2026.** Terminal-native coding agent with persistent memory, subagent orchestration, and goal-driven autonomous loops. 12.8K★. MIT.

📝 Code Models

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Specialized for code generation, completion, and analysis.

- MAI-Code-1-Flash (Microsoft) — **Jun 2026.** Microsoft's open-weight coding model for lowering infrastructure costs.
- DeepSeek Coder — State-of-the-art open-weight code generation. DeepSeek's coder series leads SWE-bench. MIT license.

- Qwen2.5-Coder (Alibaba) — Highly capable code model series (1.5B–32B). Excellent balance of speed and quality. Apache 2.0.
- Codestral (Mistral) — Mistral's dedicated code generation model — fill-in-the-middle, completion, and instruction.
- CodeGemma (Google) — Google's Gemma architecture fine-tuned for code completion and instruction. Apache 2.0.
- StarCoder2 (BigCode) — Transparently trained code model covering 619 languages. OpenRAIL-M license.
- Yi-Coder (01.AI) — Efficient coding model with strong long-context understanding. Yi License (Apache 2.0 compatible).
- Granite Code (IBM) — IBM's enterprise-grade code model, available in multiple sizes. Apache 2.0.
- Phi-4-mini (Microsoft) — Lightweight model optimized for reasoning and code. Punches above its weight class. MIT license.
- Qwen3-Coder-Next (Alibaba) — **Early 2026.** Latest generation of Qwen's code series. Strong reasoning and long-context coding capabilities. Apache 2.0.
- CodeLlama (Meta) — **Aug 2023.** Llama 2-based code generation pioneer. Supports infilling, completion, and instruction. Llama 2 Community License.
- WizardCoder (WizardLM) — **2023.** Evol-Instruct fine-tuned for complex coding tasks. Strong general code generation performance. Apache 2.0.
- OpenCodeInterpreter — **2024.** Integrates execution feedback to iteratively improve generated code. Bridges generation and execution. Apache 2.0.
- Stable Code 3B (Stability AI) — **Aug 2023.** Lightweight 3B code model optimized for fill-in-the-middle. Efficient for local autocompletion. StabilityAI license.
- CodeGeeX2 (THUDM) — **2023.** Multilingual code model supporting 20+ languages. Strong in both Chinese and English code tasks. Apache 2.0.
- CodeT5+ (Salesforce) — **2023.** Encoder-decoder architecture unifying code generation, completion, and understanding. BSD-3 license.
- SantaCoder (BigCode) — **2023.** Light 1.1B model specialized for Python, Java, and JavaScript. Fast and efficient for IDE integration.

🧬 Embedding Models

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Free, open-weight embedding and reranker models for semantic search, RAG, and text representation.

- Qwen3-Embedding (Alibaba) — **2K★.** #1 on MTEB multilingual leaderboard. Sizes: 0.6B/4B/8B. 32K context, MRL support, instruction-aware. Includes reranker models. Apache 2.0.

- BGE-M3 (BAAI) — Multi-lingual (100+ languages), multi-functionality (dense, sparse, colbert), multi-granularity (8K tokens). MIT.
- FlagEmbedding (BAAI) — **12K★.** Framework and model zoo: BGE series, BGE-VL (multimodal), bge-en-icl, bge-multilingual-gemma2 (9B multilingual SOTA). MIT.
- nomic-embed-text-v2 (Nomic AI) — **1.5B** MoE embedding model. 8192 context. Matches or exceeds OpenAI text-embedding-3-small. Apache 2.0.
- mxbai-embed-large-v1 — **0.3B** lightweight embedding. Top of MTEB among sub-0.5B models. Apache 2.0.

🔍 RAG & Vector Databases

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Free tools for building retrieval-augmented generation pipelines — vector storage, embedding search, and document retrieval.

- Chroma — AI-native open-source embedding database. Runs in-process, no GPU needed. GitHub
- Qdrant — High-performance vector search engine. Free tier on Qdrant Cloud or self-host via Docker. GitHub
- pgvector — Vector similarity search inside PostgreSQL. Free if you already run Postgres.
- LanceDB — Developer-friendly vector database built on Lance columnar format. Runs locally, no server needed. GitHub
- Weaviate — Open-source vector database. Free sandbox tier on Weaviate Cloud. GitHub
- Milvus (Zilliz) — Cloud-native vector database. Free tier on Zilliz Cloud or self-host. GitHub
- txtai — AI-powered semantic search and RAG in a single Python package. GitHub
- R2R (SciPhi) — Production-ready RAG engine with API, user management, and observability. **Note: Last release Jun 2025. Consider alternatives like Dify or LangGraph.**
- Docling (IBM) — Document understanding and conversion for RAG pipelines. Extracts PDFs, images, and more. GitHub
- Unstructured.io — Preprocessing toolkit for documents (PDF, HTML, Word) for RAG pipelines. Free tier available.
- GraphRAG (Microsoft) — Modular graph-based RAG pipeline. Extracts a knowledge graph from unstructured text via LLM prompting, then answers over it with community-summarization for better global/abstractive queries than vector-only RAG. MIT license. GitHub

🧩 Agentic Frameworks

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Free, open-source frameworks for building AI agents and multi-agent systems.

- LangGraph (LangChain) — Low-level framework for building stateful, multi-agent applications. GitHub
- CrewAI — Multi-agent framework for orchestrating specialized AI agents to work together. GitHub
- AutoGen (Microsoft) — Extensible framework for building multi-agent conversations. **Note: In maintenance mode (last push Apr 2026).** GitHub
- Agno (formerly Phidata) — Full-stack AI framework for building multimodal agents with memory, knowledge, and tools. GitHub
- PydanticAI — Agent framework by Pydantic with type-safe outputs and dependency injection. GitHub
- Mastra — TypeScript framework for building AI applications and agent workflows. GitHub
- OpenAI Agents SDK — Lightweight SDK for building single and multi-agent systems. GitHub
- Semantic Kernel (Microsoft) — SDK for orchestrating AI agents with planners, memory, and connectors. GitHub
- Dify — LLM app development platform with visual workflow builder and agent capabilities. GitHub
- Flowise — Low-code visual LLM flow builder with drag-and-drop interface. **Note: Acquired by Workday; repo archived (read-only) Aug 13, 2026.** GitHub
- Fazm — **Apr 2026.** Open-source local computer-use agent for macOS. Drives apps via accessibility APIs, model-agnostic, faster than screenshot-based agents.
- Smolagents (Hugging Face) — Minimalist agent library where agents "think in code." Lightweight, zero boilerplate. Supports code agents and tool-calling agents.
- Swarms — Enterprise-grade multi-agent orchestration framework. Scalable infrastructure for autonomous agent swarms. Highly modular. **Actively maintained (last push Aug 2026).**
- Letta (MemGPT) — Framework for long-term agent memory. Virtual memory management that pages data in/out of context like an OS. Persistent agents.
- Griptape — Enterprise agent framework with strictly typed Pipelines, Workflows, and Agents. Structure-first, production-ready.
- Atomic Agents — Framework inspired by Atomic Design. Compose agents from small, reusable, modular components. Testable and scalable.
- PraisonAI — Low-code multi-agent framework. Define agent roles, tasks, and flows via YAML configuration. Wraps underlying agent frameworks.
- Cognee — GraphRAG framework for agent knowledge management. Builds interconnected knowledge graphs from unstructured data.
- MetaGPT — Multi-agent framework simulating a full software team. Assigns Agent, Product Manager, Engineer roles. Implements SOPs for end-to-end code generation. **Note: Active development (last push Jan 2026).**
- ChatDev (OpenBMB) — Virtual software company driven by multi-agent collaboration. Follows waterfall model through design, coding, testing, and documentation.
- AutoGPT — The original autonomous agent experiment. Sets its own goals, iterates on tasks, and executes without continuous human input. Web browsing and file management.

- Bee Agent Framework (IBM) — Production-ready framework for building reliable AI agents in Python and TypeScript. Modular, with built-in observability and IBM research optimizations.
- Eliza (elizaOS) — Multi-platform agent framework for creating character-driven AI agents. Handles social media interaction, complex decision-making, and autonomous behavior across platforms.
- Qwen-Agent (Alibaba) — Agent framework tightly integrated with the Qwen model family. Optimized for function calling, code execution, RAG, and tool use with Qwen models.
- AGiXT — Extensible modular AI agent automation platform. Plugin system for swapping LLMs, memory backends, and tools. Highly customizable agent workflows.
- Microsoft Agent Framework — **12.9K★.** Production-grade multi-agent framework for Python and .NET. Graph-based workflows, streaming, human-in-the-loop. MIT.
- GenericAgent — **13.8K★.** Minimal, self-evolving autonomous agent framework. ~3K lines core, 9 atomic tools. Self-crystallizing skill tree from every task. MIT.
- Omnigent — **9K★.** Open-source meta-harness orchestrating Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, Pi, and custom agents. Real-time collaboration from any device. Apache 2.0.

🔧 MCP Servers & Tools

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers that connect AI assistants to external tools, data sources, and APIs.

- GitHub MCP Server — **32.4K★.** Official GitHub MCP server by GitHub. Repository management, issue/PR automation, CI/CD intelligence, code analysis. OAuth or PAT auth. MIT license.
- GitMCP — **8.3K★.** Free, open-source, remote MCP server for any GitHub project. Zero-setup documentation and code access for AI assistants. Apache 2.0.
- MCP Reference Servers (Anthropic) — **89.7K★.** Official reference implementations: Filesystem, Git, Fetch, Memory, Time, Sequential Thinking. Apache 2.0 / MIT.

🎛️ Fine-tuning Tools

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Tools to fine-tune free models on your own data — all free and open-source.

- Unsloth — Fast memory-efficient fine-tuning. 2x faster, 50% less memory. Supports QLoRA, LoRA, full fine-tune.
- Axolotl — Streamlined fine-tuning framework supporting multiple model architectures and quantization methods.

- LLaMA-Factory — Easy-to-use fine-tuning with web UI. Supports 100+ models, multiple training methods.
- Hugging Face TRL — Transformer Reinforcement Learning library. SFT, PPO, DPOTrainer, GRPOTrainer for aligning models.
- XTuner (InternLM) — Efficient fine-tuning toolkit supporting QLoRA, LoRA, and full fine-tune with multiple model architectures.
- Ludwig (Predibase) — Declarative ML framework. Fine-tune models with a simple config file. GitHub

✨ Prompt Engineering Tools

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Free tools for testing, managing, and optimizing prompts.

- Promptfoo — **Company acquired by OpenAI; repo actively maintained (last push Aug 2026).** Open-source tool for prompt testing and evaluation. Systematic A/B testing of prompts. GitHub
- Fabric (Daniel Miessler) — Open-source framework for augmenting humans with AI. Library of curated prompts (patterns) for common tasks.
- LangFuse — Open-source LLM engineering platform with prompt management, versioning, and evaluation. GitHub
- DSPy (Stanford) — Framework for algorithmically optimizing LM prompts and weights. GitHub
- Agenta — Open-source LLM platform for prompt management, evaluation, and deployment. GitHub

📊 LLM Evaluation & Observability

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Free, open-source tools for tracing, evaluating, and monitoring LLM applications in development and production.

- Langfuse — **33.4K★.** Full LLM engineering platform: tracing, evaluations, prompt management, playground, datasets. Self-hostable. MIT (core). GitHub
- Opik (Comet) — **21.5K★.** Open-source LLM observability, evaluation, and agent tracing. Datasets, experiments, LLM-as-judge, guardrails, prompt management. Apache 2.0.
- Phoenix (Arize AI) — AI observability platform with OpenTelemetry-based tracing, evals, experiments, and prompt playground. Elastic License 2.0.
- TruLens — **3.5K★.** Agent-specific evaluations (7 purpose-built evaluators). OpenTelemetry tracing, MCP support, batch and inline evaluation. MIT.

- OpenLLMetry (Traceloop) — **7.4K★.** OpenTelemetry-based LLM observability. Send traces to any OTLP-compatible backend. Apache 2.0.

📊 Datasets

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Free, open datasets for training, fine-tuning, and evaluating models.

- Hugging Face Datasets — The standard hub for open datasets. 150,000+ datasets across all tasks.
- Common Corpus — Massive open-source dataset for training large language models. **(May require Hugging Face login; HTTP 401 at check time).**
- The Stack v2 (BigCode) — Large-scale code dataset covering 619 programming languages. Permissive license.
- FineWeb (Hugging Face) — High-quality web dataset for LLM pre-training. 15T tokens.
- Dolly (Databricks) — 15k instruction-response pairs for fine-tuning. CC-BY-SA.
- OpenAssistant Conversations — 160k human-generated assistant conversations. Apache 2.0.
- ShareGPT (RyokoAI) — Real user-ChatGPT conversations for fine-tuning.
- UltraChat (Sean C.) — 200k multi-turn conversations synthesized by ChatGPT.
- No Robots (Hugging Face) — 10k high-quality human-written instructions. Apache 2.0.
- MMLU / GSM8K — Standard benchmarks for evaluation.
- CodeAlchemy (IBM) — **Jul 2026.** ~1T tokens of synthetic code across 15 languages. Includes 1.3M code+execution-trace pairs. Permissive license.

☁ Model Hosting Platforms

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Free platforms that host models — run inference without downloading anything.

- Hugging Face Spaces — Free hosting for ML apps (Gradio, Streamlit). Thousands of community demos.
- Hugging Face Inference Endpoints (Free Tier) — Deploy models with free trial credits.
- Google Colab (Free Tier) — Free GPU (T4, sometimes A100). Perfect for running models and fine-tuning.
- Kaggle Notebooks — Free GPU (T4 x2). 30 hours/week. Good for heavier workloads.
- Lightning AI Studio — Free tier with GPU access for development and prototyping.
- Modal — Free monthly credits for serverless GPU compute.

- Replicate (Free Tier) — Free credits for running community models.
- Deepnote — Free tier with GPU for data science and ML notebooks.
- Zylora — Deploy GPU functions from any language. Free tier: $5 GPU credits/month, no credit card. T4/L4 pool, sub-300ms cold starts.

📚 Learning Resources

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

Free courses, books, and tutorials for learning AI and LLMs.

- Fast.ai — Code-first deep learning education. Practical, free courses from fundamentals to advanced.
- Hugging Face LLM Course — Comprehensive free course on transformers, tokenizers, datasets, and deployment. **Note: renamed from "NLP Course."**
- DeepLearning.AI Short Courses — Free short courses on LLMs, RAG, LangChain, and AI agents.
- Full Stack Deep Learning — Free course on ML engineering: training, deploying, and maintaining models.
- Andrej Karpathy's Course — From-scratch neural network implementation videos.
- Neural Networks: Zero to Hero — YouTube series building neural networks from scratch.
- Prompt Engineering Guide (DAIR.AI) — Comprehensive free guide on prompt engineering techniques.
- Anthropic Cookbook — Free recipes and patterns for working with Claude.
- OpenAI Cookbook — Free examples and guides for the OpenAI API.
- LearnLLM.dev — Free AI engineering course with 110+ lessons, runnable code, in-browser playground. Covers fundamentals to production agents.
- LLM Zoomcamp (DataTalksClub) — Free 10-week course on building LLM applications with RAG, agents, vector search, and evaluation.
- AI Engineering from Scratch — **2026.** 503 lessons across 20 phases. Build LLMs, agents, and MCP servers from scratch. MIT. 47K+ stars.

🏆 Resources & Leaderboards

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

- Perplexity — Free AI search and research assistant with real-time answers and source citations. **(HTTP 403 at check time; may block automation).**
- BenchLM.ai — **New.** LLM leaderboard with 281 models compared across 8 categories. Verified benchmark data updated weekly.

- Hugging Face Open LLM Leaderboard — The primary benchmark for open-weight models. Updated regularly.
- LMSYS Chatbot Arena — Human preference rankings of models. Best source for real-world quality comparisons.
- Artificial Analysis — Independent benchmarks for speed, pricing, and quality across providers.
- Hugging Face Models — Search 1M+ models. Filter by license, task, framework.
- OpenRouter Models — Browse models available via API with pricing and free tiers.
- Ollama Library — Browse models available for one-command local setup.

👥 Communities

> 📅 Last checked: August 19, 2026

- Hugging Face Discord — Model releases, discussions, and community support.
- r/LocalLLaMA — The largest Reddit community for running local LLMs.
- Ollama Discord — Ollama community for local model enthusiasts.
- LM Studio Discord — LM Studio community.
- Hugging Face Forums — Discussions on models, datasets, and Spaces.
- r/MachineLearning — General ML/AI research and news.
- Discord: AI Agents — Community for AI agent development and agentic frameworks.

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